THE STOP KIT: TEACHER GUIDE

How to teach students to navigate the Stop Kit · Middle and High School

The Stop Kit is a free web page that teaches students what to do before, during and after a police stop. It covers Mississippi, Washington DC, Maryland and Virginia. There's a lot on it. This guide shows you how the page is organized, how to walk students through it, and how to teach the same lessons on paper when your class has no devices.

01 AT A GLANCE

Where it lives	lawrencetotimeh.com/class/stop (QR code on the Student Packet)
Time	One 50-minute overview, or a three-day unit (plans below).
Materials	The Stop Kit on phones, tablets or a projector. Or the printed Student Packet for every student, no devices needed.
Students will	• Say five calm lines that protect their rights during a stop. • Explain the difference between a detention and a voluntary conversation. • Get an officer's information without escalating. • Write a Stop Report using facts, not feelings. • Turn a worried question into a legal question they can research. • Explain how a complaint works and when a lawsuit is possible.
Standards	Fits civics standards on rights and responsibilities, the Bill of Rights, the justice system and evaluating sources (for example, the C3 Framework civics and inquiry strands). Match it to your state's standards.

02 BEFORE YOU TEACH

- **Some students have been stopped.** Some have family members who were hurt or arrested. Give a quiet option and check in after class.
- **The goal is safety first, accountability second.** The Stop Kit's rule: during the stop, your only job is to get home safe. The fight happens after, on paper.
- **Keep it nonpartisan.** This is about rights every person has, not about any party or candidate.
- **Don't name real officers or local incidents** in class. Use the fictional scenarios in this guide.
- **Role-play carefully.** The adult plays the officer, calmly and politely. Never have students act out force, yelling or arrests.
- **Educator, not an attorney.** Agent Kodak is an educator. The Stop Kit is civic education, not legal advice. For a real case, students should talk to a lawyer or public defender.

03 HOW THE PAGE IS BUILT

At the top are three big buttons. Each one jumps to the right section. Below them is a row of seven tabs. Tapping a tab opens that section. The page saves nothing, and students never have to log in.

Button or tab	What students find there	Packet section
"I just got stopped"	Jumps straight to the Stop Report.	Part 4
"Teach me first"	Jumps to the five rules.	Part 1

"I have a question"	Jumps to the Ask Better question builder.	Part 5
Before	Five rules for any stop, with examples. Extra rights for students under 18 in all four places. Can I record?	Part 1
What if?	Seventeen real moments. Tap a question to open the answer. Phones, IDs, passengers, school officers, "we just want to talk," getting arrested anyway.	Part 2
Script	"Before they leave." How to get the officer's name, badge, department and report number without saying anything that hurts you.	Part 3
Stop Report	A form students fill out after a stop. It builds a written report and opens their own email to send it to themselves. Includes "Facts, not feelings."	Part 4
Ask Better	Turns "What happens to me if…" into "What does the law say about…" and builds Google searches. Includes "Is this source legit?"	Part 5
Report It	Where to file a complaint in each of the four places, in what order, and how to get records.	Part 6
Accountability	Complaint vs. lawsuit, what happens after a complaint, qualified immunity, and deadlines by place.	Part 7

Tip: each tab has its own web address. Add #report, #whatif, #script, #ask, #followup or #accountability to the end of the link to send students straight to one section.

04 PLAN A: ONE CLASS PERIOD (50 MINUTES)

Step	Min	What happens
Warm-up	5	Ask: "If an officer stopped you on the way home, what would you say first?" Write answers on the board. Keep them for the end.
Tour	8	Project the page. Show the three buttons, then tap each tab once. Students follow along on their own devices or in the packet.
Five lines	10	Teach the five lines (Part 1 of the packet). Students say each one out loud, calmly. Practice with a partner.
What if?	12	Small groups each take two What If questions. They read the answer, then teach it to the class in one sentence plus the line to say.
Facts, not feelings	10	Students rewrite the three feeling statements in Part 4 as facts. Share two out loud.
Exit	5	Return to the warm-up board. Which answers would help? Which could make a stop worse? Exit ticket: write the five lines from memory.

05 PLAN B: THREE-DAY UNIT

Day	Focus	Packet
Day 1 During the stop	The five rules. Under-18 rights. What If card sort: students sort the scenario cards into "I can say no," "I must do it" and "Ask first." Role-play with the teacher as the calm officer.	Parts 1 and 2
Day 2 After the stop	The "Before they leave" script. Then students write a full Stop Report from the fictional scenario in section 06. Peer review: circle every feeling word and turn it into a fact.	Parts 3 and 4
Day 3 Accountability	Ask Better questions practice. Report It for your state. Complaint vs. lawsuit. Discussion: "Why file a complaint if most don't end in discipline?"	Parts 5, 6 and 7

06 PLAN C: NO DEVICES

Everything in the Stop Kit is in the printed Student Packet. Print one per student, single or double sided. The interactive parts become paper activities:

- **The Stop Report** becomes a fill-in form (Part 4). Students keep it, or take a photo of it later.
- **The question builder** becomes a worksheet (Part 5). Students write the better question, then pick whose law applies.
- **Report It** is a printed table for all four places (Part 6). Circle your place.
- **The wallet card** on page 1 is meant to be cut out and kept.

If one projector is available, project the page during the tour and use the packet for everything else.

Fictional practice scenario (use for the Stop Report)

Jordan is 16 and is walking home from practice at 6:40 PM on a Tuesday, near the corner of Oak Street and 5th Avenue, by the laundromat. A city police car pulls up. An officer gets out and says, "Hey, come here. Where you headed?" Jordan says, "Home." The officer says, "You match a description. Let me see some ID." Jordan says, "Officer, am I free to go?" The officer says, "Not right now." Jordan asks, "What's the reason I'm being stopped?" The officer says, "Somebody reported a break-in." The officer asks, "Mind if I check your bag?" Jordan says, "I don't consent to any searches." The officer looks in the bag anyway. After about 15 minutes, the officer says, "You're good, go home." The name tag says Officer Reyes. The car number on the back is 214. Jordan didn't get a card or a report number.

This scenario is made up. Any resemblance to a real person or event is a coincidence.

07 ANSWER KEYS

Part 1: The five lines

1. **Am I free to go?**
2. **I'm choosing to remain silent.**
3. **I don't consent to any searches.**
4. **I want a lawyer. I want my parent.**
5. **May I have your name and badge number?**

Part 2: Card sort (I can say no / I must do it / Ask first)

Scenario	Sort	Why
"Mind if I look in your backpack?"	**I can say no**	You don't have to consent to a search. If they search anyway, don't resist.
"Unlock your phone for me."	**I can say no**	Police generally need a warrant to search a phone (Riley v. California, 2014).
"Step out of the car."	**I must do it**	During a lawful traffic stop, officers can order drivers and passengers out (Pennsylvania v. Mimms; Maryland v. Wilson).
Driver: "License and registration."	**I must do it**	Drivers must show license, registration and insurance.
"Put your phone down."	**I must do it**	Follow safety orders in the moment. Write it down after.
You want to call your parent.	**Ask first**	Don't reach for your phone. Ask: "Can I call my mom? I'm under 18."
Passenger asked for ID.	**Ask first**	We found no general law in these four places making passengers show ID. Ask: "Am I required to identify myself?" Never give a fake name.
"We just want to talk."	**I can say no**	Usually voluntary. Ask "Am I free to go?" If yes, leave calmly.
A school resource officer wants to question you.	**Ask first**	A school officer is still police. Ask for your parent. In Maryland, a child in custody must talk to a lawyer first.

Part 4: Facts, not feelings (sample answers)

Feeling	Fact version
"The cop was rude."	**"Officer said 'shut up' two times and pointed his flashlight in my face."**
"They searched me for no reason."	**"I said 'I don't consent to searches.' The officer searched my backpack anyway."**
"They held me forever."	**"The stop started at 6:40 PM and ended at 6:55 PM."**

Part 5: Ask better questions (sample answers)

Worried question	Better question	Whose law
"Am I gonna get arrested if I don't show ID?"	**"What does [my state] law say about showing ID when I'm walking?"**	**State**

"Can the cops go through my phone?"	**"What does the Constitution say about police searching a phone?"**	**Federal (Constitution)**
"Can the school officer question me without my mom?"	**"What does [my state] law say about police questioning a minor at school?" plus "What does my district's code of conduct say?"**	**State and school district**

Part 7: Complaint findings

Sustained = it happened and broke the rules. **Not sustained** = not enough proof either way. **Unfounded** = it didn't happen. **Exonerated** = it happened, but it was allowed.

Exit ticket quiz

1. True or false: If you say "I don't consent to any searches," police can never search you. **False. You can refuse consent, but officers may still search if they have legal grounds. Don't resist. Write it down.**
2. "I'm not detaining you, but you're not free to go." Are you detained? **Yes. If a reasonable person wouldn't feel free to leave, you're detained.**
3. Can police lie to you during questioning? **Often, yes. Virginia is the exception for children in custody, since 2025.**
4. What number should you ask for so you can request the report and video later? **The report or incident number.**
5. Why file a complaint if it might not lead to discipline? **It creates a record. Several complaints about the same officer tell a story, and records can matter in future cases.**

08 DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- Why does the Stop Kit say the fight happens "after, on paper"? Do you agree?
- Why might a report that sticks to facts be more powerful than one that describes feelings?
- Officers' body cameras record you too. How can that protect you?
- Why do the rules for minors differ between Mississippi, DC, Maryland and Virginia? Should they be the same?
- "A record that doesn't exist can't protect the next kid." What does that mean?

Facts on the Stop Kit were checked Oct. 8, 2026. Laws change. Check the live page for updates. Agent Kodak is an educator, not an attorney. This is civic education, not legal advice. @AgentKodak